G Major

Scale Practice Worksheet · One sharp — F♯ · 4 octaves

SCALES

01 Scale — Parallel Motion

Play G major scale up and down in parallel motion (both hands moving in the same direction).

TIP
Don't start too fast. You want to warm up and get used to the keyboard first. Start slow, prioritize evenness over speed.

02 Scale — Voicing Variations

Play the G major scale while deliberately shifting the dynamic balance between hands:

a Push the left hand louder than the right — voice out the left hand so it's not passive.

b Push the right hand louder than the left — focus attention on the right hand tone.

TIP
Voicing practice keeps scales from becoming mindless repetition. Listen to each hand independently while both are playing.

03 Scale in Thirds

Play the G major scale in intervals of a third — two notes a third apart, played together or in succession.

TIP
If the left hand feels awkward, isolate it. Practice left hand alone before combining.

04 Scale in Sixths

Play the G major scale in intervals of a sixth — two notes a sixth apart, played together or in succession.

TIP
Sixths are wider than thirds and require more hand awareness. Keep the wrist flexible and let the arm guide the position shifts.

05 Scale — Contrary Motion

Play G major with hands moving in opposite directions — one ascending, one descending simultaneously.

SIMPLIFICATION METHOD
Start with one octave, one hand alone — learn the thumb-to-third-finger connection. Then two octaves, one hand, very slow. Then both hands in contrary motion, one octave only. Then two octaves with both hands. Build outward from there. Don't be intimidated by the full four-octave version — work up to it gradually.

06 Accent & Rhythmic Variations

Apply these to any scale exercise for fluidity and evenness:

a Accent every note — extra weight on each individual note.

b Accent every second note — grouped, rolling feel.

c Triplet groupings — organize the scale in groups of three.

IMPORTANT
Keep a very clear rhythmical formula when playing scales. Without a clear rhythmic structure, you lose the passage — you touch wrong keys because you didn't prepare fast enough.

07 Arpeggios

Play **G – B – D** broken triads across 4 octaves, with inversions.

> **TECHNIQUE**
> Feel the natural weight of your arm dropping into the keys. Move in circular motions — stay grounded and free, not rigid. Increase speed gradually.

08 Broken Chords

Play tonic chord **G – B – D** in broken form (root position) across the keyboard.

> **TIP**
> If uncomfortable, practice left hand separately first. The left hand naturally wants to lean right — be aware of this pull.

09 Chords

Play solid chords (all notes struck together), with inversions.

Warm-up method: First play just the octave (G to G). Then add the middle voices (B, D) one at a time. This activates the inner fingers while the octave frame stays stable.

10 Long Arpeggios

Extended arpeggios across the full keyboard. Root position, 1st inversion, 2nd inversion. Add contrary motion.

Practice method: Separate hands first — this exposes weaknesses you hide when both hands play together. Train the left hand independently. Excellent exercise for training the thumb crossing.

11 Diminished Chord Exercises

Built on the 7th degree of G major: **F♯ – A – C** (all minor thirds). This chord stretches all muscles in the hand, trains arm expansion, and builds stamina.

If the full chord with added octave is too difficult (especially for smaller hands), play it without the octave — just the three-note chord.

11a Diminished — Chords

Play solid diminished chords across the keyboard with inversions.

TECHNIQUE
Keep a very relaxed back. Think about flexible wrists — don't lock your hands. Don't play only from the fingers. Always use the whole arm.

11b Diminished — Arpeggios

Play broken triads of the diminished chord across the keyboard.

VARIATION
Prolong the first note, relax on it, then play the remaining notes. Then prolong the second note instead. Relaxing on prolonged notes trains you to release tension between movements.

11c Diminished — Broken Chords

Play the diminished chord in broken form across the keyboard. This teaches you to expand the arm, incorporate the wrist, and stay close to the keyboard.

TIP
Practice with rhythmic variations (e.g., long-short-long-short patterns). Always practice separate hands — the left hand is weaker, especially the 3rd and 4th fingers in this stretched position.

11d Diminished — Long Arpeggios

Play extended diminished arpeggios across the full keyboard. Play through all inversions: root, 1st, 2nd, 3rd. Add contrary motion.

Fingering rule: `Thumb on the last white key (C)`. In the right hand, thumb on the first white key.

> **TIP**
> Increase speed gradually. When you don't prepare fast enough, you touch other keys — it's all about good preparation.

11e Diminished — Octave Variation

Play the diminished chord in octaves: `4th finger on F# (black key)`, `5th finger on white key`.

> **TIP**
> Use a clear rhythmic formula (e.g., triplets) to maintain accuracy.

11f Diminished — Warm-Up Variation

Play octaves first, then activate the middle fingers one at a time. This combines octave stability with inner-voice activation.

DOMINANT — D7

12 D7 Exercises (Arpeggios, Broken Chords, Chords, Long Arpeggios)

Repeat exercises 7–10 using **D – F♯ – A – C** (V7 of G major). Play through all inversions: root, 1st, 2nd, 3rd.

> **TIP**
> The dominant 7th requires a bigger hand stretch (4 notes instead of 3). Don't play these at the very start of your warm-up — hands need to be loose first. Apply rhythmic variations from Exercise 6.

FINISHING

13 Chromatic Scale

Play the chromatic scale starting from G across the full keyboard. A good way to close out your session.

GENERAL PRACTICE PRINCIPLES

- Don't start too fast — warm up first, get used to the keyboard
- Keep a very clear rhythmical formula — without clear rhythm, you lose the passage
- Use the whole arm, not just the fingers — keep wrists flexible, back relaxed, don't lock your hands
- You can always minimize the requirements — don't be intimidated, make it easier and build up
- Stamina matters — when your muscles start to burn, the exercise is doing its job
- Use variations to train relaxation — prolong a note, relax on it, then continue
- Separate hands is the savior from any problem — especially the left hand
- Everything is about preparation — bounce back from the key and prepare for the next position before you arrive
- Stay close to the keyboard, especially during broken chords and arpeggios
- Scales practice is about creativity — find variations, set goals, make it faster, more even, try new patterns
- Voice out each hand separately — push left hand volume, then right hand volume, to keep both hands engaged